

The Boy Who Came Back

There was nothing unusual about Monday. Except that everyone hates it.

The sun hit my eyes, as I stepped off my car. I arrived at school late enough to avoid the morning crowd but early enough that nobody could accuse me of actually being late.

I walked through the hallway, my bag hanging from one shoulder. Some students are chasing their friends, and others are getting stressed over the upcoming exams.

A teacher was standing outside a classroom, tears visibly swelling up in his eyes.

“Man, is he okay?.” I muttered to myself.

I reached my classroom and dropped into my chair. “Morning,” Joaz said.

“Morning.”

“You finished the history assignment?”

I stared at him.

“It’s history for a reason.” I said.

“Yeah, you’re right.” As he murmurs sarcastically

I laughed.

Then the bell rang.

After she checked the assignment—of course I got a detention. Our history teacher had decided to discuss the old school archives that day.

The archives were kept in a small room beneath the library. Nobody liked going there because the room smelled like dust, old paper, and apparently the librarian who would shush you up for every step you took.

Our teacher placed a stack of documents on the table. The loud thump and scattering dust stole everyone's attention.

"That's heavy." As she wipes a sweat

"these records goes way back before the school was rebuilt," she explained, swatting the dusts away.

Almost every student rushed to her table to take a look into it.

I picked up one, there was a photograph attached to it.

A boy stood in front of the old school building. It was snowy, the usual trees wasn't even there yet.

He looked younger than me. Dark hair, plain uniform, an expression that gives you goosebumps just by staring at it.

"Wow, this dude must be old now." I talked under my breath.

Underneath the photograph was a name.

Elias Vale.

"What a fancy name." I joked.

I read the paragraph beneath it.

Student missing during the winter term of 1987.

My face went pale, I knew something was off.

I looked at the teacher.

"What happened to him?"

She hesitated, her breath hitched for a moment.

"Nobody knows."

That answer piqued my interest.

Not because I enjoyed mysteries.

Well.

Maybe a little.

But there was something about the wording.

Nobody knows.

Not he disappeared.

Not he was never found.

Nobody knows.

I looked at the photograph again.

Elias was holding something. [A small Bible.](#)

I frowned.

“Why is he holding that in the middle of the winter, outside??”

The teacher glanced at it, trying to remember why.

“If I’m not wrong.. he carried it everywhere.”

“Did they find the Bible?”

She shook her head. “No.”

I looked back at the photograph. For some reason, I suddenly felt cold.

That evening, I stayed behind. I told myself it was because I wanted to look through the archives.

That was technically true, as a shiver ran down my spine.

I found Elias's file again.

There were only a few pages.

Attendance records, teacher reports, a handwritten note.

And one final page.

It contained a sentence written in ink that had faded almost completely.

He said he heard someone calling his name beneath the chapel.

I stared at it. "Our school has a chapel?"

The voice behind me answered.

"Yes."

I turned. Nobody was there.

I stood completely still.

Then I laughed quietly.

"Okay. Very funny." Nothing answered.

I picked up the file.

And then I noticed something.

The photograph was different.

Elias was no longer looking at the camera.

He was looking directly at me.

I dropped it.

The next morning, everyone was talking about the old case. Apparently, someone had found something in the abandoned chapel.

A Bible.

Old, covered in dust, with a name written inside.

Elias Vale.

I immediately knew something was wrong. Because the Bible had supposedly disappeared with him, right?

I went to the chapel after school, the door was already open. Inside, the air was cold. There were rows of broken wooden chairs and faded windows that painted strange shapes across the floor. Even the sun refused to shine the inside of this chapel.

At the front stood a small wooden cross.

I walked closer.

There was writing carved underneath it.

“What is hidden will be brought into the light.”

I recognized the verse. Luke.

My stomach tightened.

Then I heard footsteps behind me.

I turned.

A boy stood in the doorway, old-fashioned uniform, dark hair, young. The same face from the photograph.

Elias.

Realizing that, I stumbled. The tension was unreal, it's my first time to have witnessed a ghost.

For several seconds, neither of us spoke. It was obvious that my hands were trembling, and my legs gave up at the moment.

Then I was able to say the first thing that came into my head

“Are you a ghost?!” I shouted.

He tilted his head, not answering the question immediately.

“That is your response?”

I tried to stand up and run, but time feels like it froze exactly the moment I lifted up my body.

“Do not be afraid.”

“How am I supposed to not be afraid??” my breath nearly ran out.

"I'm not here to harm you."

He smiled. It was eerie.

"I knew you would come." He said, his voice's calm.

I paused, looking at him in confusion.

"What do you mean? Why? Why me?" I said with a trembling voice.

"Because you always look."

"Look at what?"

"Everything."

That sentence hit harder than it should have.

Elias stepped into the chapel.

"They said I was missing," he said.

"You were..?" I hesitated.

"No." His voice cuts through the tension.

He looked toward the cross.

"I was hidden."

I said nothing, as I slowly regained my composure.

He continued.

“Years ago, someone in this school discovered something. Records being changed, money being taken, and.. a lot.”

“And you.. happen to found out?”

He nodded.

“I tried to tell them.”

“But they made everyone believe I was the problem.”

My hands tightened around the old Bible.

“They made sure nobody searched for me.”

The chapel suddenly felt much smaller. But somehow.. it feels safe here.

“What happened to you?” I gathered the courage to ask.

Elias looked at me.

“I died.”

Silence.

I swallowed. Thoughts began to reel in my mind.

He almost laughed.

Then his expression changed.

“But I came back.”

His eyes moved toward the cross.

“Not to punish them.”

“Then why..?”

“To tell the truth.”

The next morning, I found the school archives unlocked. Inside was a new file, I had never seen it before. It contained names.

Teachers.

Students.

Administrators.

Some were still alive, some were not.

And at the bottom was one name I recognized immediately.

My own.

I stared at it.

“No.”

Behind me, a voice whispered.

“You were never supposed to find this.”

I turned.

Nobody.

The lights flickered, then the chapel bell rang.

Once.

Twice.

Three times.

I ran outside, students were gathering in the courtyard. Their faces are terrified, as if they just saw a ghost.

And in that instance, I realized. Everyone was looking toward the chapel. Elias stood at the top of the stairs.

But this time, everyone could see him.

A teacher screamed.

Someone dropped their books.

The principal went completely pale.

Elias looked across the crowd.

Then he pointed toward the oldest building on campus.

“There.”

Everyone followed his finger.

The building had been locked for decades, but the door was slowly opening.

I looked down at the Bible in my hands.

A page had turned by itself.

There was only one sentence written there.

"The truth will set you free."

I looked back at Elias.

He was gone.

The door stopped moving.

Nobody spoke.

Then I noticed something. The Bible was not the same one I had found yesterday, this one was new.

Clean. And tucked inside it was... a photograph.

A photograph of Elias.

Taken in 1987.

Standing beside someone else.

Someone whose face had been carefully **torn away**.

On the back was a handwritten message.

"You found the first one."

I stared at it.

The school bell rang again.

And somewhere beneath the oldest building, something knocked three times.

I looked at Joaz.

He looked at me.

“Please tell me you heard that.”

“I heard it.”

“Are we going in?”

I stared at the locked building.

Then at the photograph.

Then at the Bible.

“Of course not!”

Joaz blinked confusingly, but he accepts it right away.

“Finally, a common sense here.”

I smiled nervously.

“We’re going to find out who opened the door first.”

He stared at me, dumbfounded.

“Are you serious?”

And somewhere, far beneath the school, a boy who had been dead for thirty-nine years began to laugh.

Not because he was happy.

Because he knew something we didn’t.

And whatever happened in 1987...

Was never finished.